

ET.

by Olivia Lee

Ōdī et amō.

Quārē id faciam fortasse requīris.
Nesciō, sed fierī sentiō
et **excrucior**.

Catullus 85

Catullus 85 was one of the first poems I translated in Latin, because it is syntactically simple.

I hate. And. I love.

The sentiment that follows is resonant, although my translation is extravagant.

Why am I like this?
I don't know.
But I feel it happening...
and I am tortured.

I'm drawn to dichotomies because I struggle to break out of them. If I am not the best, then I am evil. I am full of love and hate...but apathy is unknown to me and the color gray unseen.

ET. is a coded translation of Catullus 85, in which I've remediated the elegy using my collected creative writing. Using a corpus of words semantically tagged as emotive, outlandish, sharp, and round, I drew from both my writing and the corpus, assigning sharp-leaning words to replace odi and round-leaning words to replace amo. I also used my writing to train a word-level Markov chain (N=3) to generate the final outcome of each stanza.

Sources:

Parrish, Allison. "Shoestrings Tutorial." Shoestrings Tutorial , 2024. <https://github.com/aparrish/shoestrings/blob/main/shoestrings-tutorial.ipynb>.

Parrish, Allison. "Approaches to Vector Semantics." Approaches to Vector Semantics, 2024. <https://github.com/aparrish/rwet/blob/master/approaches-to-vector-semantics.ipynb>

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import random
text = open("./oiee_writing_dirty.txt").read()
sentences = sentencex.segment("ven", text)
sentences = [item.replace("\n", " ") for item in sentences if len(item.strip()) > 0]

lex_odi = {}
lex_amo = {}
lex_odi = {key for key, val in cats.counted.items() if val['emotive'] > 2 and val['sharp'] > 1 or
            val['outlandish'] > 2 and val['sharp'] > 1}
lex_amo = {key for key, val in cats.counted.items() if val['emotive'] > 2 and val['round'] > 1 or
            val['outlandish'] > 2 and val['round'] > 1}

lex_amo_clean = {}
lex_odi_clean = {}

for word in lex_amo:
    if word in lex_amo_clean:
        continue
    else:
        lex_amo_clean.append(word)

for word in lex_odi:
    if word in lex_odi_clean:
        continue
    else:
        lex_odi_clean.append(word)

odi = {}
amo = {}

for sentence in sentences:
    for item in lex_odi_clean:
        if item in sentence:
            odi.append(item)

for sentence in sentences:
    for item in lex_amo_clean:
        if item == "ass":
            continue
        elif item in sentence:
            amo.append(item)

amo_clean = {}
odi_clean = {}

for word in amo:
    if word in amo_clean:
        continue
    else:
        amo_clean.append(word)

for word in odi:
    if word in odi_clean:
        continue
    else:
        odi_clean.append(word)

why = ["quâre", "why"]
you = ["you fortasse ask", "you might ask", "might requiris", "fortasse requiris"]
but = ["sed", "but"]
feel = ["iferi sentiô", "I feel it happening"]
know = ["I don't know", "nescio"]
et = ["et", "and"]

gen = TextGenerator(n=3, tokenizer=SimpleWordTokenizer(), source=sentences)

for i in range(20):
    print("\n")
    print(random.choice(odi_clean) + " " + random.choice(amo_clean))
    print(random.choice(why) + ", " + random.choice(you))
    print(random.choice(know))
    print(random.choice(but) + " " + random.choice(feel))
    print(random.choice(et) + " " + gen.generate_one(start_string="I am", max_tokens=5))

```

[illegible]

evil et others
quārē, fortasse requīris
I don't know
sed I feel it happening
and I am not the acolyte

past et sleep
why, might requīris
I don't know
sed I feel it happening
and I am not the point

charge et world
why, might requīris
I don't know
sed fierī sentiō
et I am and I started

past et kind
why, you might ask
I don't know
but I feel it happening
and I am nothing but the

charge et poor
why, you fortasse ask
I don't know
but fierī sentiō
et I am and I can

The result is a dichotomous spiral
where two
becomes
one
becomes
two again.

I am one person, but I am torn.
one person, torn.

smile et sleep
quārē, fortasse requīris
I don't know
but I feel it happening
and I am a voice of

evil et kind
quārē, you might ask
nesciō
sed fierī sentiō
and I am a voice of

charge et silence
why, you fortasse ask
nesciō
sed I feel it happening
and I am not the acolyte

past et love
quārē, might requirīs
nesciō
sed I feel it happening
et I am burdened by the

smile et other
why, might requirīs
nesciō
sed I feel it happening
et I amand I have

evil et god
why, you fortasse ask
nesciō
but fierī sentiō
and I am necessary.

I am one person, but I am torn.
one person,
one person, but I am torn.
I am one person, but I am torn.
one person,
one person, but I am torn.
one person,
one person, but I am torn.

evil et world
why, you might ask
nesciō
sed fierī sentiō
and I am nothing but the

evil et other
why, fortasse requīris
I don't know
sed I feel it happening
et I am what you deserve

evil et silence
why, might requīris
nesciō
but fierī sentiō
and I am[that]

evil et kind
quārē, you might ask
I don't know
sed fierī sentiō
et I am not the point

evil et sleep
quārē, fortasse requīris
I don't know
but fierī sentiō
et I am revenge and pain

quārē, fortasse requīris
grief et wrong
I don't know
sed I feel it happening
et I am bluer than I

why, fortasse requīris
smile et world
nesciō
sed fierī sentiō
and I am bluer than I

quārē, fortasse requīris
truth et world
nesciō
sed fierī sentiō
et I am necessary.